

7-DAY INTERVIEW READINESS ROADMAP

Implementation Engineer, Customer Support (APAC) | Bitwarden

Goal: go from resume-ready to interview-ready in 7 days. Each day mixes 2–3 hours of learning with 1–2 hours of hands-on practice — reading alone won't hold up under “walk me through it” questions. Use free/official docs and a local Docker setup wherever possible so you're troubleshooting real things, not just memorizing definitions.

DAY 1 — Networking & Web Fundamentals

~4-5 hrs

TOPICS

- TCP/IP basics, how a request travels client → server
- DNS: records (A, CNAME, MX, TXT), resolution flow, propagation
- HTTP/HTTPS: methods, status codes, headers, cookies vs sessions
- TLS/SSL and certificates: handshake overview, why HTTPS matters
- SMTP basics (how email delivery works, common failure points)

RESOURCES (free)

- MDN Web Docs — HTTP overview & status codes
- Cloudflare Learning Center — DNS, TLS/SSL, HTTP guides (free, very clear)
- “How DNS Works” comic (howdns.works)

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Run `dig` / nslookup` on 3 real domains; identify A, MX, TXT records`
- Use browser DevTools Network tab to inspect a real request/response cycle
- Explain out loud, from memory, what happens when you type a URL and hit Enter

BE READY TO ANSWER

- What happens when DNS resolution fails?
- How does HTTPS/TLS work, at a high level?
- What's the difference between a 401 and a 403?

DAY 2 — Identity Fundamentals: AD, LDAP & Directory Services

~4-5 hrs

TOPICS

- What a directory service is; Active Directory core concepts (users, groups, OUs)
- LDAP: structure, binds, common use cases
- Cloud directories: Azure Entra ID, Okta, JumpCloud, Google Workspace — how they differ from on-prem AD
- Authentication vs. Authorization (the core distinction interviewers probe)

RESOURCES (free)

- Microsoft Learn — “Active Directory Domain Services overview”
- Okta “What is LDAP” and “Identity 101” blog explainers
- Azure Entra ID free documentation overview

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Sign up for a free Okta or JumpCloud developer/trial account; create a test user and group
- Diagram (on paper) how a login request flows from user → directory → application
- Write a 3-sentence plain-English explanation of LDAP you could say out loud

BE READY TO ANSWER

- How would you troubleshoot an LDAP connection issue?
- What's the difference between authentication and authorization?
- How is a cloud directory like Entra ID different from on-prem AD?

DAY 3 — SSO Deep Dive: SAML, OIDC & SCIM

~5-6 hrs

TOPICS

- SAML: assertions, IdP vs SP, the login redirect flow
- OpenID Connect (OIDC): tokens (ID token vs access token), relation to OAuth 2.0
- SAML vs OIDC: when each is used, key differences
- SCIM: automated user provisioning/deprovisioning, lifecycle management

RESOURCES (free)

- Okta Developer Blog — “SAML vs OIDC” and “What the Heck is SCIM” (excellent, free, widely used)
- Auth0 “How SAML Authentication Works” and “OIDC explained” docs
- SCIM.cloud protocol overview page

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Draw the full SAML login flow (user → SP → IdP → assertion → SP) from memory
- Set up a free SSO test app (e.g. Okta's sample SAML/OIDC app) and walk through an actual login
- Write your own 60-second answer to “what happens when a user logs in through SAML?”

BE READY TO ANSWER

- What happens when a user logs in through SAML?
- What's the difference between SAML and OIDC?
- How does SCIM provisioning work end to end?

DAY 4 — Cloud, Linux & Containers

~5-6 hrs

TOPICS

- Linux fundamentals: filesystem, permissions, processes, common CLI troubleshooting commands
- Windows/macOS basics relevant to support (services, logs, network settings)
- Docker: images vs containers, common commands, reading container logs
- NGINX as a reverse proxy — why it's used, basic config concepts
- AWS / Azure / GCP: core services overview (compute, storage, IAM) — breadth, not depth

RESOURCES (free)

- Docker's official “Get Started” guide
- DigitalOcean community tutorials — NGINX reverse proxy explained (free, practical)
- AWS/Azure/GCP “core concepts” free intro pages (skim all three for vocabulary)

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Install Docker; run a container, intentionally break it, and practice `docker logs` / `docker exec` to debug it
- Set up a basic NGINX reverse proxy locally in front of a simple app
- Practice 10 everyday Linux troubleshooting commands (ps, top, netstat/ss, journalctl, curl, ping, traceroute)

BE READY TO ANSWER

- How would you debug a Docker container that won't start?
- What is an NGINX reverse proxy, and why would you use one?
- Walk me through troubleshooting a Linux server that's not responding.

DAY 5 — APIs, Webhooks & Support Troubleshooting

~4-5 hrs

TOPICS

- REST API fundamentals: verbs, status codes, idempotency
- Authentication for APIs: API keys, OAuth 2.0 flows, tokens
- Webhooks: how they work, retries, signature verification
- Reading logs and HTTP responses to diagnose a failure

RESOURCES (free)

- Postman Learning Center — free REST API & webhook tutorials
- Stripe/Twilio API docs — excellent real-world examples of clean API + webhook design
- “OAuth 2.0 Simplified” by Aaron Parecki (free online book, very readable)

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Use Postman to call 2–3 public APIs; deliberately trigger a 400/401/404/500 and read the response
- Build a simple webhook receiver (even a small n8n flow) and test it end to end
- Practice explaining a real n8n workflow you built — what could break it and how you'd debug it

BE READY TO ANSWER

- How would you troubleshoot an API returning a 500 error?
- What's OAuth, in plain terms, and where have you used it?
- Walk me through one of your n8n automations and how you'd debug it if it failed.

DAY 6 — Product Knowledge & Applied Scenarios

~4-5 hrs

TOPICS

- Bitwarden specifically: core product, SSO/SCIM integration docs, admin console basics
- Common customer-support scenarios: failed login, broken SSO integration, provisioning mismatch
- Certificate/network troubleshooting scenarios (expired cert, DNS misconfig, firewall block)
- How to structure a troubleshooting answer out loud (symptom → hypothesis → check → fix)

RESOURCES (free)

- Bitwarden Help Center — SSO/SAML/OIDC setup docs and admin guides (read as if you support it tomorrow)
- Bitwarden's public API/developer docs
- Your own AI Waste Recognition / RAG project notes — refresh so you can speak to them fluently

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Install Bitwarden (free tier), explore vault, org admin console, and any SSO setup screens
- Do 5 mock troubleshooting scenarios out loud: “a customer says SSO login is failing — walk me through it”
- Write 3 STAR-format stories from your projects/experience (Situation, Task, Action, Result)

BE READY TO ANSWER

- How would you troubleshoot an SSO integration that suddenly stopped working?
- Tell me about a time you solved a technical problem for someone non-technical.
- Why Bitwarden, and why this implementation/support role specifically?

DAY 7 — Full Mock Interview & Final Review

~3-4 hrs

TOPICS

- Timed run-through of all “Be Ready to Answer” questions from Days 1–6
- Resume walkthrough: be ready to speak to every bullet, especially Mad Media & Web
- Behavioral questions: strengths/weaknesses, why this role, career goals
- Light review only — no new topics; sleep and confidence matter more today

RESOURCES (free)

- Your own notes from Days 1–6 (rewrite key answers in your own words, don't just re-read)
- A friend, mentor, or even Claude to run a mock interview and give feedback

HANDS-ON PRACTICE

- Do one full mock interview end-to-end, timed, out loud (not just in your head)
- Identify your 2 weakest topics from the week and do one final focused review pass
- Prepare 2–3 thoughtful questions to ask the interviewer about the role/team

BE READY TO ANSWER

- Describe what you're looking for in your next job (have your 200-word version ready).
- Walk me through your resume.
- What would you do in your first 30 days in this role?

FINAL CHECKLIST BEFORE THE INTERVIEW

- Resume matches what you can actually discuss — no keyword you can't explain
- You can whiteboard/verbally walk the SAML login flow and the OIDC flow without notes
- You've broken and fixed at least one Docker container, one API call, and one DNS lookup yourself
- You have 3 STAR stories ready and a tight 200-word “what I'm looking for” answer
- You've explored Bitwarden's product and SSO docs specifically

Note: this is an aggressive 1-week plan. The goal isn't to become an expert in identity/networking/cloud in 7 days — it's to genuinely understand the fundamentals well enough to reason through interview questions rather than recite keywords. Be honest in the interview about what's new learning vs. deep experience; interviewers respond far better to “I've been building this up this week and here's how I think about it” than to overclaiming.